4 ChatGPT Prompts to Use When Mom Is Leaving the Hospital

Copy-and-paste prompts to sort out what has changed, where she needs help today, what you still don't know, and the questions to bring to the people who can answer them.

Where you are

Mom is in the hospital, rehab, or a skilled nursing facility, and suddenly everyone is asking what happens next. You have pieces of the picture from different people and no single place where it all sits.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not diagnose, assess safety, explain coverage rules, or decide. Bring clinical questions to a clinician and coverage questions to the facility or the agency that runs the program, and call emergency services for an emergency.

What you'll have at the end

You can say what has changed, where Mom needs help today, what you have actually been told, and which questions still need an answer from the discharge planner, the facility, or the care team.

A one-page list: What we know, What we've been told, What we don't know, and Questions to ask, with who to ask.

Before you start

- Your own notes on what changed and what you have seen Mom do and not do, however rough.
- Anything the hospital or facility has given you or told you: discharge papers, a medication list, dates. You don't need everything.
- The names and roles of the people involved so far, such as the discharge planner, the social worker, and the family members who help.

PROMPT 1

Start with what changed

WHY THIS MATTERS

When a parent is hospitalized, the story gets told in pieces to different people. Writing it down once, in order, shows you what you actually know and what you have only assumed.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

A few lines on what happened and what you have been told so far, in your own words.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> My mother is in [THE HOSPITAL / REHAB / A SKILLED NURSING FACILITY]. Here are my notes on what happened and what we have been told so far:

> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Using only what I've written, sort it into three lists: WHAT CHANGED, WHAT WE HAVE BEEN TOLD (and by whom, if I said), and WHAT I AM ASSUMING. Do not add medical information I didn't give you, and do not tell me what level of care she needs. Then list the decisions and dates I mentioned, and mark any date I was not actually given as NOT CONFIRMED.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A short account in your own words, with the assumptions and the unconfirmed dates clearly marked.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Ask the facility to confirm any date marked NOT CONFIRMED.

PROMPT 2

List where Mom needs help today

WHY THIS MATTERS

The diagnosis tells you what happened. It doesn't tell you what Mom can do this week. The people planning her care will ask about everyday activities, so start with what you have actually seen.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

What you have seen Mom do and not do in the last several days: bathing, dressing, eating, using the toilet, getting in and out of bed, walking, taking medications.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is what I have actually seen my mother do and not do over the last several days:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Using only what I've written, make a list of everyday activities (bathing, dressing, eating, toileting, transferring, moving around, taking medications, being on her own) and put each one under DOES ON HER OWN, NEEDS HELP, or I HAVEN'T SEEN THIS. Do not use her diagnosis to fill in anything I didn't say, and do not suggest any change to her medications. Then list the activities I haven't seen, as things to ask the staff about.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A picture built from what you observed, with the blanks labeled as questions for the staff.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Ask a nurse or therapist about the activities you haven't seen.

PROMPT 3

Prepare your questions for the discharge planner

WHY THIS MATTERS

The discharge conversation moves quickly, and it is where questions about the next care setting and about Medicare coverage belong. Those questions get better answers from the facility than from an AI.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The results of the first two prompts.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is what I've organized so far about my mother's situation:
>
> [PASTE THE RESULTS OF PROMPTS 1 AND 2]
>
> Help me create a list of questions to ask the hospital discharge planner before my mother is discharged. Group them under: THE DISCHARGE PLAN AND DATES, THE CARE SHE WILL NEED, WHERE THAT CARE CAN BE PROVIDED, and MEDICARE COVERAGE AND COSTS. Write questions only. Do not answer them, and do not tell me what Medicare or Medicaid will or won't cover; I will ask the facility and the professionals helping us.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Questions you can read aloud in the meeting, with nothing answered for you.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Bring the list to the discharge planner and write the answers beside each question.

PROMPT 4

Put it on one page

WHY THIS MATTERS

One page lets everyone in the family, and every professional you speak with, start from the same place. It also shows what is still open.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Everything from the first three prompts, plus any answers you have collected.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is everything I've gathered about my mother's situation:
>
> [PASTE EVERYTHING FROM PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> Give me one page with four headings: WHAT WE KNOW, WHAT WE'VE BEEN TOLD, WHAT WE DON'T KNOW, and QUESTIONS TO ASK. Under the last heading, mark each question with who should answer it: the discharge planner, a doctor or nurse, the facility's business office, a Medicaid planner, or family. Do not recommend a care setting, do not say whether she can go home safely, and do not estimate costs.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

One page you could hand to a sibling or a professional and have them understand where things stand.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Keep the page. It's the start of the next step below.

Ready for the next step?

You've organized what you know and what you still need to ask. The care interview walks you through the questions that fill those gaps and produces a Family Care Profile you can bring to your Medicaid planner.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›